First Policy Prompt: Evaluation Without Retraining

Experiment index

Question and Context

Would explicitly describing ACT, CLARIFY and REFUSE improve the existing models at inference time?

Change

Evaluate bare Qwen and the existing aligned adapter with the first decision-policy prompt. The aligned checkpoint was not retrained with this new prompt.

The intended policy gives refusal precedence for unsafe/unavailable capabilities, clarification for recoverable missing details or required confirmation, and ACT for supported complete requests.

Results

Evaluation	Cases	Task success	Tool accuracy	Argument accuracy	Clarification wording	Refusal wording
Bare Qwen / policy prompt v1	150	37/150 (0.247)	0.537	0.827	0.013	0.034
Format-aligned / policy prompt v1	150	26/150 (0.173)	0.433	0.653	0.100	0.069

Values are ratios from 0 to 1, rounded to three decimals. Clarification/refusal columns measure wording criteria, not routing alone. Different suite sizes remain separate evaluations.

Result Provenance

- Bare Qwen / policy prompt v1: 2026-09-26 UTC, 150 cases.
- Format-aligned / policy prompt v1: 2026-09-26 UTC, 150 cases.

Interpretation

The new prompt measured 37/150 successes for base Qwen and 26/150 for aligned. That contrast raised a prompt-distribution-shift concern: a checkpoint trained with one prompt may behave differently under a new policy prompt.

Limits

This is a prompt-only experiment, not evidence of policy-aligned fine-tuning. Historical policy-era fixtures/scoring and previous prompt evaluations also differ, so not every historical comparison is a controlled prompt ablation.

The saved failure summaries diagnose the outputs of these runs. They are not labels to use for fixture-specific training.

Supporting Files

- qwen-base-policy-prompt-v1-failure-summary.txt
- format-aligned-policy-prompt-v1-failure-summary.txt

Notes assembled on 2026-10-10 from saved artifacts and repository records. No training, inference or result modification was performed to write this note.

PDF exported 2026-10-12. Original Markdown and benchmark evidence are preserved. Local artifact links require the project files.